

QA Sample Report: Silent Failures

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Selected findings from a client-facing voice analytics and alerting platform. Product, client and environment details are anonymised and figures are rounded; the analysis and evidence are my own work.

Why these three

None of these produced an error message. Every screen looked healthy, every button responded, and every dashboard rendered a number. They were found by checking the system against itself: UI figures against direct database queries, network traces against downloaded files, and confirmation toasts against what was actually persisted.

#	Finding	Severity	Visible symptom
1	Dashboard panels disagree on the same metric	High	None. All panels render normally
2	Excel export never completes	High	Spinner runs forever, no error
3	Alerts confirm firing but deliver nothing	High	"Condition triggered" toast appears

1. Dashboard panels report the same metric with a gap of roughly 12,000 records

Severity: High

Observed

On a 7-day window, three panels on the same page reported the same underlying metric differently. The KPI card and the ranking table agreed on roughly 46.37 million attempts. The traffic summary table on the same page showed about 12,000 fewer. A fourth panel reported a per-region total slightly higher than the page-level total, which cannot be a subset of it.

Why it is not refresh timing

The same pattern held on a static historical window, not just the live view, so it cannot be explained by panels refreshing seconds apart.

Assessment

The panels appear to resolve the same window through different queries or filters. In a reporting product this is more damaging than a crash: the customer sees a plausible number and has no signal that it is wrong.

2. Excel export hangs indefinitely while CSV works

Severity: High

Observed

On dataset views, CSV export produced a correct file: header row present, every row matching the on-screen table exactly. Excel export from the same view showed a loading spinner that never resolved, on every dataset tried, with no error surfaced to the user.

Evidence

The browser network trace showed the export request stuck in Pending, under half a kilobyte sent, no response ever returned, which distinguishes a hanging request from a failed one.

Also noted

A separate gap in the same area: the main report page offers no export option at all, in either format. Export exists only on the underlying dataset views.

3. Alert engine confirms firing but persists nothing

Severity: High

Observed

Six alert conditions were configured with schedules and an email channel. Triggering them manually returned a "Condition triggered" confirmation each time, but the notification log recorded no new entry, before or after refresh.

Deeper inconsistencies in the same area

Every condition showed its Active toggle off while still carrying trigger history. The configured channel was email, yet all historical notifications (over two thousand) were recorded as delivered through a different channel, with the email counter at zero. The large majority of those were marked Skipped with a row count of zero and an unresolved dataset reference.

Assessment

The alerting path reports success at the UI layer while nothing downstream is recorded or delivered. For a monitoring product, silent non-delivery is the worst possible failure mode.

How these were found

- **Cross-checking the UI against the source.** Dashboard figures were reconciled against direct database queries, and exported files against on-screen row counts, rather than being accepted at face value.
- **Reading the traffic, not the screen.** Network traces separated hanging requests from failed ones and surfaced request-level detail the interface never showed.
- **Testing enforcement, not appearance.** Read-only roles were verified by extracting a valid session token and calling mutating endpoints directly, confirming the server rejects them rather than checking whether a button was hidden.
- **Following defects to root cause.** Where possible, findings were traced to the exact function and error in the backend, so the report tells a developer where to look instead of only what broke.

Prepared by Huzaifa Aamish, Senior QA Engineer. Sanitised sample for portfolio use; no client, product or environment identifiers are included and figures are rounded.